

10 Ways to Ruin a Biofloc System

(and What That
Teaches You to Avoid)



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1. Underestimating Oxygen Demand

The Fail: Stock high, feed heavy, and assume one blower can handle it.

What Really Happens: Floc communities consume oxygen 24/7. Shrimp do too. At night, respiration skyrockets. Starving the pond of O_2 is the fastest road to mortality.



2. Running Aeration Like It's Optional

The Fail: Switch aeration off at night to save power.

What Really Happens: In biofloc, oxygen drops within minutes of shutdown. By dawn, your pond looks more like a graveyard than a farm.

3. No Backup Power

The Fail: Assume the grid is eternal and storms are polite. What Really Happens: A two-hour blackout is enough for mass die-off. Villarreal-García (2022) showed aeration failures are the common thread in system collapses.

4. Cheap, Ineffective Aerators

The Fail: Use surface paddles that just stir water.

What Really Happens: They don't oxygenate deep enough, leaving solids to settle and create anaerobic pockets. Hydrogen sulfide enters the party.

5. Ignoring Solids Management

The Fail: Assume floc will balance itself.

What Really Happens: Excess solids clog shrimp gills and boost bacterial oxygen demand. A pond full of sludge is not “nutrient-rich”—it’s suffocating.

6. Forgetting Redundancy

The Fail: One blower is enough;
why buy two?

What Really Happens: The day it
breaks, your whole system goes
with it. Redundancy isn't luxury—
it's insurance.

7. Overfeeding Without Balancing Carbon

The Fail: Dump in protein feed without carbon supplementation.

**What Really Happens:
Ammonia spikes, microbes work overtime, oxygen crashes. Carbon:nitrogen balance isn't a suggestion, it's the system's backbone.**

8. Assuming

Aeration = Mixing

The Fail: Toss in some bubbles and call it good.

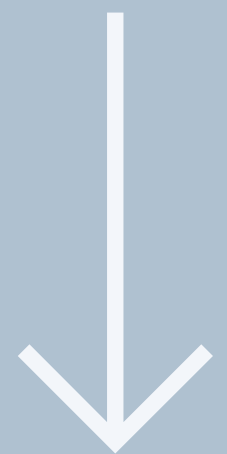
What Really Happens: Poor circulation means dead zones where solids settle and oxygen doesn't reach. Even with air, parts of your pond suffocate.



9. Ignoring Monitoring

The Fail: Test dissolved oxygen once a week.

What Really Happens: Oxygen levels swing hourly, especially at night. Without real-time monitoring, you're farming blind.



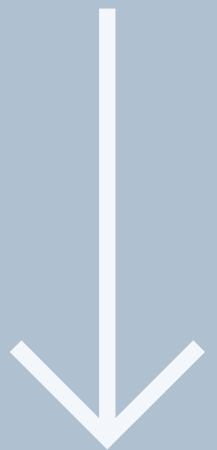
10. Treating Biofloc as “Set and Forget”

The Fail: Believe the myth that biofloc runs itself.

What Really Happens: Biofloc is a living system—bacteria, solids, oxygen, nutrients—constantly in flux. Neglect is the surest way to convert it into a sludge reactor

Take-Home:

Every “don’t” points back to one truth: oxygen and aeration are the non-negotiables in biofloc. Ignore them, and you’re not running a shrimp farm—you’re running an expensive experiment in mass mortality.



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and ideas**

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